AEGIS BANK

Employee Handbook

Enterprise AI Decision & Knowledge Platform for Modern Banking

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Confidentiality Notice

This Employee Handbook is the property of **Aegis Bank** and is intended exclusively for authorized employees, contractors, and approved stakeholders.

The information contained within this document includes internal policies, operational standards, employment guidelines, and organizational procedures that are confidential to Aegis Bank.

Unauthorized disclosure, duplication, distribution, modification, or use of this document outside the organization is strictly prohibited and may result in disciplinary action, termination of employment, legal proceedings, or regulatory consequences.

Employees are responsible for protecting all confidential information contained within this handbook and ensuring compliance with organizational security requirements.

Table of Contents

1. Introduction
2. Purpose
3. Scope
4. Company Overview
5. Mission, Vision & Core Values
6. Employee Responsibilities
7. Standards of Professional Conduct
8. Equal Employment Opportunity
9. Workplace Ethics
10. Communication Guidelines
11. Attendance & Working Hours
12. Leave Policy Overview
13. Remote Work Guidelines
14. Information Security
15. Data Privacy & Confidentiality
16. Acceptable Use of Technology
17. AI Usage Guidelines
18. Performance Management
19. Learning & Development
20. Health & Safety
21. Disciplinary Procedures
22. Employee Exit Process
23. Frequently Asked Questions
24. Revision History

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1. Introduction

Welcome to **Aegis Bank**.

We are committed to delivering secure, innovative, and customer-centric banking services by combining modern financial technologies with Artificial Intelligence, cybersecurity, and regulatory excellence.

Our employees represent the foundation of our organization. Every individual contributes to maintaining the trust our customers place in us every day.

This handbook provides the policies, standards, responsibilities, and behavioral expectations applicable to every employee working within Aegis Bank.

Employees are expected to familiarize themselves with this handbook and comply with all applicable organizational policies throughout their employment.

This handbook should be read together with departmental policies, regulatory procedures, cybersecurity standards, and operational manuals issued by the Bank.

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2. Purpose

The purpose of this Employee Handbook is to establish a consistent framework governing employment practices throughout Aegis Bank.

Specifically, this handbook aims to:

- Define employee rights and responsibilities.
- Promote ethical and professional workplace behavior.
- Ensure compliance with banking regulations.
- Maintain operational consistency.
- Protect confidential customer information.
- Support a secure and inclusive work environment.
- Encourage continuous learning and professional development.
- Strengthen organizational accountability.
- Promote responsible AI adoption within banking operations.

- Support business continuity through standardized procedures.

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3. Scope

This handbook applies to:

- Full-Time Employees
- Part-Time Employees
- Contract Employees
- Temporary Staff
- Interns
- Consultants with internal system access
- Third-party vendors performing on-site work
- Remote employees
- Hybrid employees

The policies outlined within this handbook apply across all Aegis Bank offices, operational centers, regional branches, and approved remote working environments.

Failure to comply with these standards may result in disciplinary action in accordance with Human Resources procedures.

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4. Company Overview

About Aegis Bank

Aegis Bank is a modern financial institution focused on providing secure, reliable, and technology-driven banking services.

The organization integrates Artificial Intelligence, cloud technologies, cybersecurity, and enterprise knowledge management to enhance operational efficiency while maintaining strict regulatory compliance.

Core banking services include:

- Retail Banking

- Corporate Banking
- Commercial Lending
- Digital Banking
- Credit Card Services
- Investment Services
- Treasury Operations
- Customer Support
- Fraud Detection
- AI-Assisted Knowledge Management

Aegis Bank maintains a strong commitment to customer privacy, information security, regulatory compliance, and ethical banking practices.

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5. Mission

To provide trusted, secure, and innovative financial services that empower individuals and businesses while maintaining the highest standards of integrity, regulatory compliance, and customer satisfaction.

Vision

To become a globally recognized AI-enabled banking institution delivering secure financial services through innovation, operational excellence, and responsible use of emerging technologies.

Core Values

Integrity

We act honestly, ethically, and transparently in every business decision.

Customer First

Customers remain at the center of every policy, service, and operational process.

Security

Protecting customer assets and information is our highest operational priority.

Innovation

We continuously improve our services through technology, Artificial Intelligence, and digital transformation.

Accountability

Every employee is responsible for the quality, accuracy, and security of their work.

Collaboration

Success is achieved through teamwork, respect, knowledge sharing, and open communication.

Compliance

Every activity performed within Aegis Bank must comply with applicable laws, banking regulations, and internal governance standards.

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6. Employee Responsibilities

Every employee is expected to:

- Maintain professionalism at all times.
- Protect confidential information.
- Follow all organizational policies.
- Comply with banking regulations.
- Report security incidents immediately.
- Maintain accurate documentation.

- Protect customer privacy.
- Respect colleagues and customers.
- Complete mandatory training programs.
- Follow cybersecurity requirements.
- Use Artificial Intelligence responsibly.
- Report conflicts of interest.
- Cooperate during internal audits.
- Support continuous improvement initiatives.

Employees are expected to demonstrate honesty, accountability, and professionalism while representing Aegis Bank.

7. Standards of Professional Conduct

7.1 Overview

Professional conduct is fundamental to maintaining the reputation, credibility, and operational excellence of **Aegis Bank**. Every employee is expected to uphold the highest standards of integrity, professionalism, accountability, and ethical behavior while representing the Bank.

Employees serve as ambassadors of the organization and must ensure that their actions strengthen customer confidence, regulatory trust, and organizational values.

Failure to comply with these standards may result in disciplinary action, including termination of employment.

7.2 Professional Expectations

Employees are expected to:

- Treat customers with respect and professionalism.
- Maintain honesty in all communications.

- Follow all internal policies and procedures.
- Complete assigned work accurately and on time.
- Protect confidential information.
- Cooperate with colleagues and management.
- Report unethical behavior immediately.
- Avoid conflicts of interest.
- Follow all banking regulations.
- Maintain professionalism during meetings, emails, calls, and digital communications.

7.3 Workplace Behavior

Employees shall:

- Maintain a respectful work environment.
- Refrain from discrimination or harassment.
- Avoid abusive or offensive language.
- Respect cultural diversity.
- Support teamwork and collaboration.
- Maintain appropriate professional relationships.

The Bank maintains a zero-tolerance policy toward workplace violence, bullying, intimidation, retaliation, and discrimination.

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8. Code of Conduct

Purpose

The Code of Conduct establishes the ethical standards that govern all employees of Aegis Bank.

Every employee must read, understand, and comply with this Code throughout their employment.

Ethical Principles

Employees shall always:

- Act honestly.
- Follow applicable laws.
- Protect customer trust.
- Avoid fraudulent behavior.
- Maintain confidentiality.
- Report policy violations.
- Cooperate with auditors.
- Protect company assets.
- Use organizational resources responsibly.

Conflicts of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal interests conflict with the interests of Aegis Bank.

Examples include:

- Approving loans for immediate family members.
- Hiring relatives without disclosure.
- Accepting gifts from vendors during procurement.
- Owning financial interests in competing institutions.
- Using confidential information for personal gain.

Employees must disclose any actual or potential conflict to Human Resources and the Compliance Department immediately.

Gifts & Hospitality

Employees may not:

- Accept expensive gifts from customers.
- Receive cash gifts.

- Accept luxury travel sponsored by vendors.
- Influence business decisions based on personal benefits.

Acceptable examples include:

- Company-branded promotional items.
- Modest refreshments during meetings.
- Low-value appreciation gifts approved by management.

Any gift exceeding the approved corporate threshold must be reported to the Compliance Department.

Fraud Prevention

Employees must immediately report:

- Suspicious financial transactions.
- Identity theft.
- Internal fraud.
- Document forgery.
- Unauthorized system access.
- Data manipulation.
- Expense fraud.
- Procurement fraud.

Failure to report known fraud may itself constitute a disciplinary offense.

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9. Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO)

Policy Statement

Aegis Bank is committed to providing equal employment opportunities for all qualified individuals.

Employment decisions are based solely on:

- Qualifications

- Skills
- Experience
- Performance
- Business requirements

The Bank does not tolerate discrimination based on any legally protected characteristic under applicable employment laws.

Inclusive Workplace

Aegis Bank promotes:

- Diversity
- Inclusion
- Equal opportunity
- Mutual respect
- Fair hiring practices
- Accessible workplaces

Managers are responsible for ensuring fair treatment of all employees.

Recruitment Principles

Recruitment decisions shall be based on:

- Education
- Technical competency
- Professional experience
- Interview performance
- Reference verification
- Background screening

Personal relationships or favoritism shall not influence hiring decisions.

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10. Workplace Ethics

Ethical decision-making is essential in banking because customers entrust the Bank with sensitive financial information and assets.

Employees must:

- Act fairly.
- Avoid deception.
- Protect confidential information.
- Follow compliance procedures.
- Report unethical conduct.
- Maintain accurate records.
- Avoid misuse of authority.

Confidential Information

Employees must never disclose:

- Customer account details
- Loan information
- Credit history
- Internal reports
- Employee records
- Financial forecasts
- AI models
- Security architecture
- Internal audit findings

Confidential information must only be shared with authorized personnel on a need-to-know basis.

Insider Information

Employees must never use confidential business information for personal financial benefit.

Examples include:

- Investment decisions based on confidential information.
- Sharing unpublished financial reports.
- Disclosing acquisition plans.
- Revealing customer financial information.

Violations may result in termination and legal action.

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11. Communication Guidelines

Professional communication strengthens customer confidence and promotes operational efficiency.

Employees are expected to communicate:

- Clearly
- Respectfully
- Accurately
- Professionally
- Securely
- Promptly

Email Standards

Official emails should:

- Use professional language.
- Include appropriate greetings.
- Avoid slang or offensive language.
- Protect confidential information.

- Verify recipients before sending.
- Use approved email signatures.

Sensitive information should never be transmitted through personal email accounts.

Internal Messaging

Employees should use only approved communication platforms for business discussions.

Employees must never:

- Share passwords.
- Transfer confidential customer data through unauthorized applications.
- Discuss confidential information in public spaces.
- Share screenshots containing customer information.

Meetings

Meeting participants should:

- Arrive on time.
- Prepare in advance.
- Maintain confidentiality.
- Respect differing opinions.
- Document action items.
- Follow up on assigned responsibilities.

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12. Attendance & Working Hours

Regular attendance is essential for maintaining operational continuity.

Standard business hours are established by Human Resources and may vary depending on operational requirements.

Employees are expected to:

- Arrive on time.
- Notify managers of absences promptly.
- Record working hours accurately.
- Follow attendance reporting procedures.
- Obtain approval for overtime when required.

Repeated lateness or unapproved absences may result in disciplinary action.

Flexible Working Hours

Certain departments may implement flexible scheduling based on operational needs.

Approval is subject to:

- Manager recommendation.
- Departmental workload.
- Business continuity.
- Compliance requirements.

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13. Dress Code

Employees represent the professional image of Aegis Bank.

Business attire should be:

- Clean
- Professional
- Appropriate for customer interaction
- Consistent with departmental standards

Employees working remotely should also maintain professional appearance during official video meetings.

Examples

Example 1

A Relationship Manager receives an expensive watch from a customer after approving a corporate loan.

Correct Action: Politely decline the gift and report the incident to the Compliance Department.

Example 2

An employee notices a colleague viewing customer records without authorization.

Correct Action: Immediately report the activity through the Bank's Information Security Incident Reporting Process.

Example 3

An employee accidentally sends an internal financial report to the wrong recipient.

Correct Action: Notify the Information Security Team immediately, inform the manager, and follow the Data Breach Response Procedure.

14. Leave Policy

14.1 Purpose

The Leave Policy ensures that employees have access to appropriate time away from work while maintaining business continuity and operational efficiency. Aegis Bank recognizes the importance of employee well-being, work-life balance, and compliance with applicable employment regulations.

14.2 Scope

This policy applies to:

- Full-Time Employees
- Part-Time Employees (where applicable)

- Permanent Staff
- Probationary Employees (subject to eligibility)
- Remote Employees
- Hybrid Employees

Temporary staff and contractors may be governed by separate contractual agreements.

14.3 Types of Leave

Employees may be eligible for the following leave categories:

Annual Leave

Employees are entitled to paid annual leave in accordance with their employment agreement and applicable laws.

Employees should:

- Submit leave requests in advance.
- Obtain manager approval.
- Ensure work responsibilities are properly handed over.
- Avoid scheduling extended leave during critical operational periods unless approved.

Sick Leave

Employees who are unable to work due to illness should:

- Notify their manager as soon as reasonably possible.
- Record leave through the HR Management System.
- Provide medical documentation when required.

Repeated or extended absences may require additional medical certification.

Emergency Leave

Emergency leave may be granted for unforeseen personal circumstances, including:

- Family emergencies
- Medical emergencies
- Bereavement
- Natural disasters
- Other exceptional situations approved by Human Resources

Maternity, Paternity & Family Leave

Eligible employees may receive maternity, paternity, adoption, or other family-related leave in accordance with organizational policy and applicable legal requirements.

Unpaid Leave

Unpaid leave may be approved under exceptional circumstances where business operations permit.

Approval is subject to:

- Department Manager
- Human Resources
- Operational requirements

Leave Request Procedure

Employees should:

1. Submit leave through the HR Portal.
2. Obtain manager approval.
3. Coordinate work handover.
4. Activate out-of-office notifications when applicable.
5. Return to work on the approved date unless an extension is authorized.

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15. Remote Work Policy

Purpose

Aegis Bank supports flexible working arrangements where operationally appropriate while ensuring productivity, information security, and regulatory compliance.

Remote work is a privilege, not an automatic entitlement.

Eligibility

Remote work may be approved based on:

- Job responsibilities
- Department requirements
- Security considerations
- Manager approval
- Employee performance

Certain banking operations require on-site attendance and are not eligible for remote work.

Employee Responsibilities

Remote employees must:

- Maintain a secure working environment.
- Use only Bank-issued devices where required.
- Protect confidential information.
- Connect through approved VPN services.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Lock devices when unattended.
- Attend scheduled meetings.
- Maintain normal working hours unless otherwise agreed.

Information Security Requirements

While working remotely, employees must never:

- Use public computers.
- Share corporate passwords.
- Print confidential documents without authorization.
- Allow family members to use company devices.
- Store confidential files on personal cloud storage.
- Connect through unsecured public Wi-Fi without approved protection.

Remote Work Example

Scenario:

A Financial Analyst wishes to work from another country for one month.

Correct Process:

- Submit a remote work request.
- Obtain manager approval.
- Receive HR and Information Security review.
- Verify regulatory and tax implications.
- Receive written authorization before travel.

Employees must not relocate their work location without prior approval.

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16. Employee Benefits

Aegis Bank offers competitive benefits designed to support employee well-being, professional growth, and long-term career development.

Benefits may include:

- Competitive salary
- Annual performance bonus
- Health insurance

- Retirement contributions
- Paid leave
- Employee assistance programs
- Learning and certification support
- Wellness initiatives
- Flexible working arrangements (where applicable)
- Recognition and reward programs

Benefit eligibility depends on employment type and applicable policy.

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17. Performance Management

Purpose

Performance management enables employees and managers to align individual goals with the strategic objectives of Aegis Bank.

Performance evaluations promote continuous improvement, accountability, and career development.

Performance Evaluation Criteria

Employees are evaluated on:

- Job knowledge
- Technical competency
- Productivity
- Customer service
- Compliance
- Teamwork
- Communication
- Leadership potential
- Innovation

- Ethical conduct
- Security awareness
- Continuous learning

Performance Review Cycle

Performance reviews are typically conducted:

- During probation
- Mid-year
- Annual review
- Promotion review
- Performance improvement review (if necessary)

Managers provide constructive feedback and establish measurable objectives for future performance.

Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

Employees whose performance falls below expectations may be placed on a structured Performance Improvement Plan.

A PIP may include:

- Defined objectives
- Training requirements
- Coaching sessions
- Review meetings
- Target completion dates

Failure to meet agreed improvement objectives may result in further disciplinary action.

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18. Learning & Professional Development

Continuous learning is essential in the banking industry due to evolving regulations, cybersecurity threats, financial technologies, and Artificial Intelligence.

Employees are encouraged to participate in ongoing development opportunities.

Mandatory Training

Employees are required to complete mandatory training in areas including:

- Information Security Awareness
- Anti-Money Laundering (AML)
- Know Your Customer (KYC)
- Fraud Prevention
- Cybersecurity Awareness
- GDPR & Privacy
- Code of Conduct
- Workplace Safety
- AI Usage Policy
- Responsible AI
- Data Protection
- Regulatory Compliance

Failure to complete mandatory training may result in restricted system access or disciplinary action.

Professional Certifications

Employees may pursue professional certifications relevant to their roles.

Examples include:

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- Project Management Professional (PMP)
- Certified Anti-Money Laundering Specialist (CAMS)

- Microsoft Azure Certifications
- AWS Certifications
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)
- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)

Support for certification fees may be provided subject to management approval and business needs.

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19. Career Development & Promotions

Aegis Bank promotes internal career growth whenever practical.

Promotion decisions are based on:

- Performance
- Skills
- Experience
- Leadership capability
- Business needs
- Professional conduct
- Training completion
- Compliance history

Promotions are not based solely on tenure.

Internal Mobility

Employees may apply for internal vacancies if they:

- Meet job qualifications.
- Have satisfactory performance ratings.
- Are not subject to active disciplinary action.
- Obtain manager approval where required.

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20. Employee Recognition

Recognizing employee achievements strengthens engagement and encourages excellence.

Recognition programs may include:

- Employee of the Month
- Innovation Awards
- Customer Service Excellence Awards
- Leadership Recognition
- Team Achievement Awards
- Long Service Recognition

Managers are encouraged to acknowledge outstanding contributions regularly.

Practical Examples

Example 1 – Sick Leave

An employee develops a high fever before work.

Correct Action:

Notify the manager immediately, submit a sick leave request through the HR system, and provide medical documentation if required.

Example 2 – Remote Work

A software engineer connects to the Bank's systems from a public café using unsecured Wi-Fi.

Incorrect Action.

The employee should instead use an approved secure connection (such as the Bank's VPN) and follow all remote security requirements.

Example 3 – Performance Review

An employee consistently exceeds targets, mentors colleagues, and completes all mandatory compliance training ahead of schedule.

Outcome:

The manager may recommend the employee for a high-performance rating, recognition, or promotion based on organizational needs.

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21. Information Security & Confidentiality

21.1 Purpose

Information is one of Aegis Bank's most valuable assets. Every employee is responsible for protecting customer data, financial records, intellectual property, and internal business information from unauthorized access, disclosure, modification, or destruction.

Information Security is the responsibility of every employee—not just the Information Security Department.

21.2 Employee Responsibilities

Employees must:

- Protect customer information at all times.
- Follow all Information Security policies.
- Use only approved software and devices.
- Lock workstations when unattended.
- Report suspicious activities immediately.
- Complete mandatory cybersecurity training.
- Comply with password and MFA requirements.
- Secure confidential documents appropriately.
- Dispose of sensitive information securely.
- Follow the principle of least privilege.

21.3 Confidential Information

Confidential information includes, but is not limited to:

- Customer account information
- Personal identification records
- Loan applications
- Financial statements
- Internal audit reports
- Business strategies
- AI models and prompts
- Risk assessments
- Security architecture
- Employee personnel records

Employees may only access information required to perform their assigned duties.

21.4 Data Protection

Employees shall:

- Encrypt sensitive information where required.
- Never copy confidential files to personal devices.
- Avoid discussing customer information in public areas.
- Verify recipient identities before sending confidential emails.
- Follow document classification standards.
- Immediately report suspected data breaches.

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22. Acceptable Use of Technology

Purpose

Aegis Bank provides technology resources to support legitimate business activities. Employees are expected to use these resources responsibly, securely, and professionally.

Authorized Use

Employees may use Bank systems for:

- Business communications
- Customer service
- Banking operations
- Approved software development
- AI-assisted productivity (where authorized)
- Training and professional development
- Internal collaboration

Prohibited Activities

Employees must not:

- Install unauthorized software.
- Download pirated content.
- Access illegal or inappropriate websites.
- Share passwords.
- Disable security software.
- Connect unauthorized USB devices.
- Use company resources for personal business.
- Attempt to bypass security controls.
- Create unauthorized AI models using confidential data.

Violations may result in disciplinary action, termination, and legal consequences.

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23. Artificial Intelligence (AI) Usage Guidelines

Purpose

Aegis Bank encourages responsible adoption of Artificial Intelligence to improve productivity while protecting customer information, maintaining regulatory compliance, and ensuring trustworthy decision-making.

Approved AI Usage

Employees may use approved AI tools for:

- Document summarization
- Policy retrieval
- Internal knowledge search
- Report drafting
- Coding assistance
- Risk analysis support
- Operational efficiency

All AI-generated content must be reviewed by a qualified employee before use.

Prohibited AI Activities

Employees must never:

- Upload confidential customer information to unauthorized AI platforms.
- Use AI to make final lending or compliance decisions without human review.
- Share classified internal documents with public AI services.
- Generate misleading or fraudulent content.
- Circumvent AI governance policies.

Human Oversight

AI supports decision-making but does not replace professional judgment.

Critical decisions involving loans, fraud investigations, compliance, legal matters, and customer disputes must always include appropriate human review and approval.

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24. Health, Safety & Emergency Preparedness

Aegis Bank is committed to providing a safe and healthy working environment for all employees.

Employees are expected to:

- Follow emergency procedures.
- Report hazards immediately.
- Participate in emergency drills.
- Wear identification badges.
- Comply with building access controls.
- Cooperate with emergency response teams.

Emergency Situations

Examples include:

- Fire
- Medical emergencies
- Cybersecurity incidents
- Power failures
- Natural disasters
- Security threats
- Building evacuation
- Critical system outages

Employees should follow instructions from authorized emergency personnel at all times.

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25. Disciplinary Procedures

Purpose

Disciplinary procedures promote fairness, accountability, and compliance with organizational standards.

Examples of Misconduct

Examples include:

- Repeated lateness
- Unauthorized absence
- Policy violations
- Data breaches
- Fraud
- Harassment
- Unauthorized disclosure of confidential information
- Misuse of Bank systems
- Conflict of interest
- Failure to comply with regulatory requirements

Disciplinary Process

Depending on the severity of the incident, disciplinary action may include:

1. Informal Coaching
2. Verbal Warning
3. Written Warning
4. Final Written Warning
5. Suspension
6. Termination of Employment

Serious misconduct may result in immediate termination without prior warnings, subject to applicable laws and internal procedures.

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26. Employee Separation & Exit Process

Employment may end due to:

- Resignation
- Retirement
- End of Contract
- Redundancy
- Termination
- Mutual Agreement

Exit Responsibilities

Employees must:

- Return all company property.
- Complete knowledge transfer activities.
- Return access cards and security tokens.
- Return company laptops and mobile devices.
- Complete exit interviews where applicable.
- Maintain confidentiality after employment ends.

Confidentiality obligations continue after separation from Aegis Bank.

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27. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1. Can I work remotely from another country?

Only with prior written approval from your Manager, Human Resources, Information Security, and Compliance (where applicable).

Q2. Can I use ChatGPT or other AI tools?

Only approved AI platforms may be used for business purposes. Confidential or customer information must never be entered into unauthorized AI systems.

Q3. Who should I contact if I suspect fraud?

Immediately notify your Manager, the Information Security Team, or the Compliance Department through the approved reporting channels.

Q4. What should I do if I receive a phishing email?

Do not click any links or attachments. Report the email immediately to the Information Security Team using the approved phishing reporting procedure.

Q5. Can I approve a loan for a family member?

No. This represents a conflict of interest and must be disclosed. The approval process must be reassigned to an independent authorized employee.

Q6. What happens if I accidentally expose confidential information?

Report the incident immediately to your Manager and the Information Security Team. Prompt reporting helps reduce potential risks and enables the Bank to respond effectively.

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28. Employee Acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the Aegis Bank Employee Handbook.

I agree to comply with all organizational policies, procedures, and standards described in this handbook.

I understand that failure to comply with these requirements may result in disciplinary action.

Employee Name _____

Employee ID _____

Department _____

Employee Name _____

Signature _____

Date _____

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29. Revision History

Version	Date	Description	Author
v1.0	January 10, 2026	Initial Release	Human Resources
v1.1	April 15, 2026	Updated Remote Work & Security Policies	Human Resources
v1.2	**July 24, 2026**	**Added AI Governance, Information Security Enhancements, and Compliance Updates**	**Human Resources**

Document Approval

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End of Document

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